September 27, 2023
Memo #5

Starting from the Wright and Rogers Class reading, there is a correlation between capitalism and the socioeconomic status of people in society, especially the majority. As stated in the reading, capitalism supports the notion of private markets, so the majority of trade and price regulation comes from corporations and private owners rather than the public will. This leads to those few decision makers setting the prices and labor opportunities in a way that best benefits their trade, which leads to competitive labor and higher prices. This perpetuates the socioeconomic status of most people: middle-class and lower-class workers. One large issue younger generations are facing today is getting higher education but only being able to find jobs that either do not allow them to be most productive or have long working hours with unfair pay. This leads to less opportunities for growth (such as upgrading living conditions and spending time on non-work related things) and prevents socioeconomic growth for a lot of people in the workforce. Although government-controlled markets can put too many restrictions or unfair regulations on some parts of the economy, an economy without any government regulation causes wide disparities in economic equality. Additionally, society itself puts more emphasis on having material things, such as real estate, access to social clubs (gyms, sports, community gatherings), and family image. To have all of these things and maintain a good economic standing is contradictory and puts financial pressure on people, further inhibiting the area for growth and equality.

Interesting link:
https://www.bbc.com/worklife/article/20220705-the-over-qualified-workers-struggling-to-find-a-job

If the US had more restrictions on economic activity by large corporations and private companies, would the inequality in economic status change in society?